Topic 13: Similarity Search

Simple RAG Project - Requirements Guide

Explain query vectors, stored vectors, similarity, distance, ranking, and Top-K.

What this topic requires

Only claim cosine similarity, Euclidean distance, dot product, or another metric when configuration or code confirms it.

Required understanding and workflow

1. Embed the user query.

2. Search stored vectors.

3. Rank candidates.

4. Select Top-K results.

5. Explain what K means and what happens when results are weak.

Workflow

```
User query -> query vector -> vector search -> ranked Top-K chunks
```

Evidence rule

Describe implementation only after repository inspection. Missing features must be labeled NOT IMPLEMENTED IN THIS PROJECT. Recommendations must be labeled PRODUCTION RECOMMENDATION - NOT CURRENTLY IMPLEMENTED.